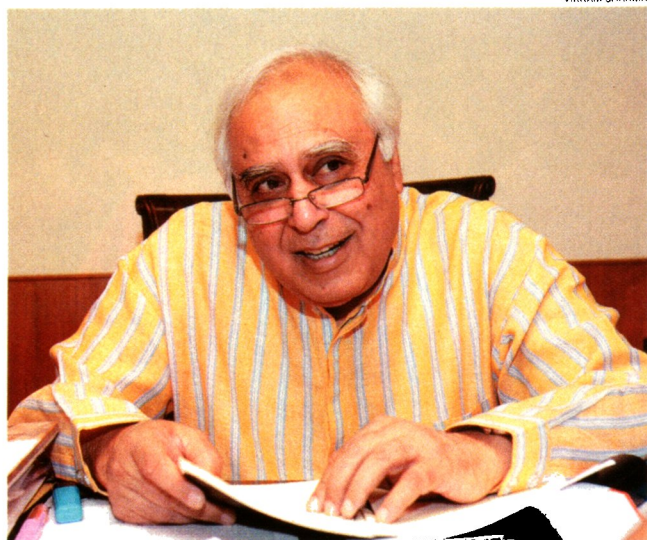


VIKRAM SHARMA



A Season to Rhyme

DELHI What does the science and technology minister do in his spare time? That is, of course, when he is not trouble-shooting for the nuclear deal. Well, he could do verse, which is precisely what Kapil Sibal has done. Recently, on a flight back from Munich, he penned a few lines on the Left. Tongue fully in cheek, he observes: *The Left has suffered for a lifetime now/of an ailment they can't diagnose. The symptom, however, that troubles them most/ is that*

they can't see beyond their nose!

Later this month, Sibal's first book of poems will be out. Aptly called *I Witness* (Roli Books), the topics vary from politics, global warming, terrorism, cricket to feminism... The last one to be included was a poem on the trust vote which he describes as "a day to remember for both betrayal and trust". Sibal says the book was an "unintended venture. I wrote these for my own enter-

HANDSET POET: Sibal wrote the verses in SMS form

tainment." Interestingly, most of them are written in SMS form on his mobile. It was when he read these out to friends at a party that someone suggested that he bring out a book.

Sibal has already made his poetic debut on the floor of the House. His poem on A.B. Vajpayee was part of his speech during the Right to Information debate. Unfortunately, he did not get to deliver his speech during the recent trust vote. He had been all set to add a poetic flourish to that as well—a few lines on carrots, the fact that they are red and a dying export from Russia and China! However, it took Khushwant Singh to persuade him to include some of his love poems as well for publishing. So the next time Sibal is debating politics on television, try imagining him penning down soulful lines as: *Within your eyes I want to see/the turning point for you and me. When I find it I will know/that now I have nowhere to go.*

by Priya Sahgal

SIGNPOSTS

DIED: Former Test player **Ashok Mankad**, 62, son of late all-rounder Vinoo Mankad. He had played 42 Tests for India and scored 991 runs.

CONFERRED: The Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award on ODI Captain **Mahendra Singh Dhoni**. This makes

him the only second cricketer after Sachin Tendulkar to be bestowed with the country's highest sporting order.

WON: The 13th Grenkeleasing Rapid World Chess Championship by **Viswanathan Anand**. It was Anand's 11th win in Mainz.

DIED: Marathi playwright and director **Chetan Datar**. He had paved the way for experimental theatre in Marathi. He was 43.

APPOINTED: **Ashwani Kumar** as the director of the CBI. He is a 1973 batch IPS officer.

VIS-A-VIS MAMATA BANERJEE Trinamool Congress chief versus BIMAN BOSE CPI(M) leader

If the Government prevents us from entering the Nano factory, they will be playing with fire and their hands will get burnt.



SAURABH SINGH

The Trinamool is trying to stir up unrest through its agitation which defies all norms of democratic protest.

EPILOGUE: The politicians refuse to give the common man a breath of relief, even for a nano-second.